

ZYPHER

ZPH

A Healthcare Payment Protocol on Solana

Dual-Token Architecture for Equitable Provider Compensation

WHITEPAPER — DRAFT v0.2

March 2026

Blockchain: Solana Mainnet | Token Standard: SPL | Decimals: 9
Total Supply: 10,000,000,000 ZPH

CONFIDENTIAL — NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary

Zypher is a dual-token healthcare payment protocol built on Solana, designed to bridge the growing gap between the cost of clinical services and the ability of underinsured and uninsured patients to compensate their providers. The protocol's governance and utility token, ZPH, is deployed as an SPL token on Solana mainnet with a total supply of 10,000,000,000 tokens (9 decimals). A companion stable settlement token, zCARE, will be developed as a custom Solana program to handle clinical payments at a stable value.

By combining a stable settlement layer with an ecosystem utility token, Zypher enables equitable provider compensation while preserving patient access to care. The protocol leverages Solana's high throughput (~65,000 TPS), sub-second finality, and transaction costs under \$0.01 to make healthcare micropayments economically viable.

[TO WRITE: Complete 2–3 paragraph executive summary covering the problem, solution, market opportunity, and competitive differentiation. Target audience: potential investors, provider organizations, and health system executives.]

2. The Problem: Healthcare's Payment Crisis

2.1 The Underinsured Gap

Approximately 27 million Americans lack health insurance entirely, while an estimated 40–45 million more are considered underinsured—meaning their coverage leaves them exposed to catastrophic out-of-pocket costs. For these patients, seeking care often means choosing between their health and financial ruin.

[TO WRITE: Statistics on medical debt, bankruptcy rates attributable to healthcare costs, and growth trends in high-deductible health plans. Source from KFF, Census Bureau, and CMS data.]

2.2 Provider Compensation Erosion

On the provider side, the economics are equally challenging. Uncompensated care costs U.S. hospitals billions annually. Independent practices and smaller provider groups bear a disproportionate share of this burden, often absorbing the cost of treating patients who cannot pay or offering steep self-pay discounts that barely cover overhead.

[TO WRITE: Data on uncompensated care, charity care write-offs, provider burnout linked to financial stress, and the impact on rural/safety-net providers. Reference AHA, MGMA, and CMS Cost Reports.]

2.3 Why Existing Solutions Fall Short

Current alternatives—sliding-scale fees, payment plans, medical credit cards, and health sharing ministries—each have significant limitations. Sliding-scale models reduce revenue. Payment plans carry high default rates. Medical credit cards impose predatory interest rates on vulnerable patients. None of these approaches fundamentally realign the incentive structure between patients and providers.

[TO WRITE: Detailed comparison table of current payment alternatives with failure modes for each.]

3. The Zypher Protocol: A Dual-Token Architecture on Solana

Zypher introduces two complementary tokens that work together to solve the healthcare payment problem: zCARE (the stable settlement token) and ZPH (the ecosystem utility and governance token). Both are built on Solana's high-performance blockchain, leveraging the SPL token standard for interoperability across the Solana ecosystem. This separation is deliberate—it isolates the payment stability providers need from the ecosystem dynamics that drive network growth.

3.1 ZPH: The Ecosystem Utility & Governance Token

ZPH is the native governance and utility token of the Zypher ecosystem. It is deployed on Solana mainnet as a standard SPL token via Smithii.io, with a total supply of 10,000,000,000 tokens and 9 decimal places. ZPH is tradeable on Raydium and discoverable through Jupiter aggregator. ZPH is not used for direct clinical payments but instead powers the governance, staking, data, and incentive layers that make the network valuable and sustainable.

3.1.1 Deployment Specifications

Token Name	Zypher
Ticker Symbol	ZPH
Blockchain	Solana (Mainnet)
Token Standard	SPL Token
Total Supply	10,000,000,000
Decimals	9
Deployment Platform	Smithii.io
Initial Liquidity	Raydium (ZPH/SOL pool)
Aggregator Listing	Jupiter (jup.ag)
Explorer	Solana Explorer (explorer.solana.com)

3.1.2 Utility Functions

[TO WRITE: Define ZPH utility across these categories: (a) Governance: voting on protocol parameters, fee structures, eligible provider types, and new feature proposals. (b) Staking: validators and liquidity providers stake ZPH to participate in network operations and earn yield. (c) Data Access: ZPH grants tiered access to Zypher's provider intelligence layer—NPI-linked provider profiles, credentialing status, network adequacy analytics, and workforce data built on NPPES/CMS/HRSA foundations. (d) Provider Credentialing: ZPH can be used to pay for on-chain credential verification services. (e) Fee Discounts: holding ZPH reduces transaction and redemption fees within the network.]

3.1.3 Supply and Distribution

ZPH has a fixed total supply of 10,000,000,000 tokens. The allocation is designed to balance team incentives, ecosystem growth, community participation, and liquidity needs over a 5-year vesting horizon.

Category	Allocation	% Total	Cliff	Vesting
Team & Founders	1,500,000,000	15.0%	12 mo	48 mo
Advisors	500,000,000	5.0%	6 mo	24 mo
Ecosystem Development	2,000,000,000	20.0%	None	60 mo
Community & Rewards	1,500,000,000	15.0%	None	60 mo
Treasury / DAO	2,000,000,000	20.0%	None	Gov-controlled
Liquidity Provision	1,000,000,000	10.0%	None	12 mo
Public Sale (TGE)	1,000,000,000	10.0%	None	Immediate
Private/Seed Investors	500,000,000	5.0%	6 mo	36 mo

3.1.4 Value Accrual

[TO WRITE: How does ZPH accrue value over time? Mechanisms include: (a) Fee capture: a percentage of all zCARE transaction fees are used to buy back and burn ZPH on Raydium. (b) Data demand: as the provider intelligence layer grows, demand for ZPH-gated data access increases. (c) Network effects flywheel model. (d) Staking lockup reducing circulating supply.]

3.2 zCARE: The Stable Settlement Token (Phase 2)

zCARE is the unit of account for clinical transactions within the Zypher network. Unlike ZPH, which is deployed immediately via Smithii.io, zCARE requires custom Solana program development (Rust/Anchor framework) to implement mint/burn authority, oracle integration, and reserve management. zCARE development will commence once ZPH governance is operational and initial protocol revenue supports the engineering investment.

3.2.1 Peg Mechanism

[TO WRITE: Define the peg target. Options: (a) Hard USD peg (1 zCARE = \$1.00), backed by fiat reserves or overcollateralized crypto assets. (b) CMS Fee Schedule Index peg—zCARE value tied to a weighted basket of Medicare reimbursement rates. (c) Hybrid approach. Detail tradeoffs, reserve requirements, Pyth/Switchboard oracle design for Solana, and update cadence.]

3.2.2 Minting and Redemption

[TO WRITE: How are zCARE tokens created? Custom Solana program with mint authority held by the protocol multisig. Collateral requirements. Redemption process for providers converting zCARE to USDC/USD via Solana-native stablecoin rails. Describe the role of authorized liquidity providers and settlement windows.]

3.2.3 Transaction Flow

[TO WRITE: End-to-end flow diagram. Patient acquires zCARE → presents to provider at point of service → provider's practice management system records zCARE payment → provider redeems or holds. Cover integration with existing billing workflows (CPT/HCPCS code association, EOB

equivalents, and reconciliation). Solana transaction confirmation times (~400ms) enable real-time point-of-care settlement.]

4. Token Economics Deep Dive

4.1 Economic Model

Attribute	zCARE (Settlement)	ZPH (Utility/Gov)
Primary Use	Clinical payments	Governance, staking, data access
Blockchain	Solana (custom program)	Solana (SPL token)
Value Target	Stable (\$1 USD or CMS-indexed)	Market-driven
Total Supply	Elastic (mint/burn on demand)	10,000,000,000 (fixed cap)
Decimals	6 (USDC-compatible)	9 (Solana standard)
Who Holds It	Patients, providers, payers	Ecosystem participants, investors
Volatility	Near-zero (by design)	Variable (market forces)
Revenue Link	Transaction volume	Fee buyback/burn + data demand
Trading Venue	Protocol-only (not speculative)	Raydium, Jupiter
Development	Phase 2 (custom Anchor program)	Phase 1 (deployed via Smithii)

4.2 Stability Mechanism Design (zCARE)

[TO WRITE: Detailed stability architecture for zCARE on Solana. Cover: (a) Reserve composition (USDC on Solana, T-bill-backed stablecoins, overcollateralized SOL). (b) Oracle design using Pyth Network and/or Switchboard for price feeds. (c) CMS data oracles (custom). (d) Arbitrage incentives. (e) Emergency mechanisms (circuit breakers, redemption queues, multisig governance intervention). (f) Comparison to existing Solana stablecoins (USDC, PYUSD) and lessons from UST/Luna collapse.]

4.3 Fee Structure

[TO WRITE: Fee model for zCARE transactions. Minting fee, transaction fee, redemption fee. Target: total round-trip cost competitive with credit card processing (2.5–3.5%). Solana's base transaction cost (~\$0.00025) makes microfee structures viable. Model fee scenarios at different volumes.]

4.4 Inflation, Deflation, and Healthcare Cost Alignment

Healthcare costs inflate at approximately 3–5% annually. ZPH has a fixed 10B supply cap with a 2.5% annual ecosystem fund emission rate, offset by a buyback-and-burn mechanism funded by 30% of protocol fee revenue. As transaction volume grows, burn pressure is designed to exceed inflation, creating net deflationary dynamics.

[TO WRITE: Model the interaction between inflation/burn dynamics and ZPH circulating supply over 5 years. Include sensitivity to ZPH price and transaction volume assumptions.]

5. Patient Token Acquisition Pathways

The fundamental challenge: if patients lack cash to pay providers directly, how do they acquire zCARE? Zypher addresses this through multiple acquisition channels designed to meet patients where they are. Note: patient acquisition of zCARE is a Phase 2 capability. In Phase 1, ZPH serves as the ecosystem bootstrapping mechanism.

5.1 Direct Purchase

[TO WRITE: Fiat-to-zCARE on-ramps. In Phase 1, users can acquire ZPH directly via Raydium/Jupiter using SOL from Coinbase, Kraken, or Cash App. In Phase 2, dedicated fiat-to-zCARE rails via MoonPay/Transak integration or custom on-ramp. KYC/AML requirements and compliance.]

5.2 Employer-Sponsored Programs

[TO WRITE: Employers fund zCARE wallets as a supplemental health benefit. Integration with payroll systems. Tax treatment considerations (Section 125 cafeteria plan eligibility, HSA coordination).]

5.3 Community Health Grants & Government Programs

[TO WRITE: FQHC and safety-net provider partnerships. Grant-funded zCARE distribution for qualifying patients. Integration with HRSA-funded programs. State Medicaid waiver opportunities for pilot programs.]

5.4 Earned Token Models

[TO WRITE: Patients earn zCARE through verified health-promoting behaviors: preventive care visits, chronic disease management compliance, health literacy course completion. Data verification through provider attestation or connected health device APIs.]

5.5 Charitable and Philanthropic Channels

[TO WRITE: Healthcare-focused nonprofits, faith-based organizations, and philanthropic foundations purchase zCARE in bulk for distribution. Donor tax treatment.]

6. Provider Compensation & Redemption

6.1 Provider Onboarding

[TO WRITE: NPI-verified provider enrollment. Phantom wallet setup for providers (or custodial wallet option for less crypto-native providers). Provider types eligible. Credentialing verification using NPPES, state licensing boards, and DEA databases—leveraging existing CI Health Group data infrastructure.]

6.2 Point-of-Service Workflow

[TO WRITE: How does a zCARE payment work at the front desk? Solana wallet-to-wallet transfer confirmed in ~400ms. Integration options: standalone Zypher terminal/app, EHR/PMS plugin, clearinghouse integration. CPT code → zCARE amount → payment confirmation → receipt flow.]

6.3 Redemption Options

[TO WRITE: Multiple off-ramps: (a) USDC conversion via Raydium/Jupiter, then fiat via Coinbase/Kraken. (b) Hold in zCARE for ecosystem purchases. (c) Convert to ZPH for governance participation and staking yield. (d) Pay staff bonuses in zCARE. Detail settlement timelines and fees.]

6.4 Provider Incentive Structure

[TO WRITE: Why would providers participate? Access to otherwise-unreachable patients, guaranteed settlement, lower fees than credit cards, ZPH staking rewards for early adopters, access to provider analytics and credentialing tools, network adequacy visibility.]

7. The Zypher Intelligence Layer

A key differentiator for Zypher is the integration of a comprehensive provider intelligence platform powered by ZPH token access. This layer transforms Zypher from a simple payment rail into a healthcare data ecosystem.

7.1 Data Sources & Integration

[TO WRITE: Foundation datasets: NPPES, CMS Fee Schedules, HRSA Area Health Resource Files, state licensing board rosters, ACGME residency data, CMS Medicare utilization files. Describe how CI Health Group's existing data infrastructure forms the backbone of this layer.]

7.2 Provider Profiles & Credentialing

[TO WRITE: On-chain provider identity tied to NPI. Credential verification stored as Solana account metadata or via Arweave/Shadow Drive for larger records. Real-time updates from licensing board integrations.]

7.3 Network Adequacy Analytics

[TO WRITE: Workforce supply/demand mapping by specialty and geography. HRSA HPSA/MUA designation overlay. ZPH-gated access for health plans and state regulators.]

7.4 Data Privacy & Compliance

[TO WRITE: HIPAA considerations. Provider data (public via NPPES/NPI) vs. patient data (PHI, never on-chain). Zero-knowledge proof options for patient eligibility verification on Solana (e.g., Light Protocol).]

8. Technical Architecture

8.1 Solana as the Foundation Layer

Zypher is built on Solana for its combination of high throughput (~65,000 TPS theoretical, ~4,000 TPS sustained), sub-second finality (~400ms), and negligible transaction costs (~\$0.00025 per transaction). For healthcare payments, these characteristics are critical: a provider accepting payment at the point of care needs confirmation in seconds, not minutes, and the per-transaction cost must be low enough to make \$20–\$200 clinical payments economically rational.

[TO WRITE: Detailed justification for Solana over alternatives (Ethereum L2s, Cosmos appchains). Address Solana network reliability concerns and mitigation strategies. Validator requirements for healthcare-grade uptime.]

8.2 Smart Contract Architecture

The Zypher protocol consists of multiple Solana programs deployed in phases:

[TO WRITE: Phase 1 programs (deployed): ZPH SPL token (via Smithii). Phase 2 programs (in development): (a) zCARE token program (custom Anchor/Rust with mint/burn authority). (b) Stability module (reserve management, Pyth oracle integration). (c) Provider registry program (NPI-linked PDAs). (d) Payment processor program (CPT code mapping, fee calculation, atomic settlement). (e) Governance program (Realms-based or custom DAO). (f) Staking program (ZPH lockup and reward distribution). Audit and formal verification strategy (e.g., Halborn, OtterSec, Neodyme).]

8.3 Oracle Design

[TO WRITE: Pyth Network for real-time price feeds (ZPH/USD, SOL/USD). Switchboard for custom data feeds. Custom CMS data oracle for fee schedule updates. Oracle decentralization and manipulation resistance on Solana.]

8.4 Interoperability

[TO WRITE: HL7 FHIR integration for EHR connectivity (off-chain API layer). X12 EDI compatibility for claims processing. Wormhole bridge for cross-chain zCARE settlement (if needed). Solana Pay integration for merchant-side QR code payments.]

9. Regulatory & Compliance Framework

9.1 Securities Classification

[TO WRITE: Howey test analysis for both zCARE and ZPH. ZPH as utility/governance token—sufficient decentralization and consumptive use analysis. zCARE as payment instrument. Reference current SEC guidance, proposed stablecoin legislation (GENIUS Act, STABLE Act), and state-level digital asset frameworks.]

9.2 Money Transmission

[TO WRITE: State money transmitter licensing requirements. FinCEN MSB registration. Strategy: partner with licensed money transmitter vs. obtain own licenses. State-by-state rollout plan.]

9.3 Healthcare-Specific Regulation

[TO WRITE: HIPAA compliance architecture. Anti-Kickback Statute analysis. Stark Law considerations. State insurance regulations. ERISA implications.]

9.4 Tax Treatment

[TO WRITE: Tax treatment of zCARE for patients and providers. ZPH staking rewards taxation. Employer contribution deductibility. IRS virtual currency guidance.]

10. Go-to-Market Strategy

10.1 Phase 1: Token Launch & Community Building (Current)

Phase 1 focuses on deploying ZPH on Solana mainnet, establishing initial liquidity on Raydium, and building community awareness. The ZPH token serves as the bootstrapping mechanism for the broader protocol.

[TO WRITE: Deployment checklist (Smithii → Raydium → Jupiter → Solana Explorer verification). Community channels (Twitter/X, Discord, Telegram). Initial messaging: “ZPH is the governance token for the Zypher healthcare payment protocol. The zCARE stable settlement token is in development.” Early adopter incentives. Contract address publication strategy. Almar DM outreach and partnership development.]

10.2 Phase 2: Proof of Concept

[TO WRITE: Target DFW metropolitan area. Partner with 3–5 independent primary care practices and 1–2 FQHCs. Deploy zCARE custom program. Patient cohort: self-pay and high-deductible plan patients. Duration: 6–12 months after zCARE launch. Success metrics: provider adoption rate, patient satisfaction, transaction volume, and redemption patterns.]

10.3 Phase 3: Regional Expansion

[TO WRITE: Expand to multiple Texas metros. Add specialty providers. Introduce employer-sponsored programs. Launch ZPH governance and staking. Target: 50–100 providers, 5,000–10,000 patients.]

10.4 Phase 4: National Scale

[TO WRITE: Multi-state rollout. Health system partnerships. Payer integration. Full provider intelligence layer launch. Target: 1,000+ providers, 100,000+ patients.]

10.5 Phase 5: Ecosystem Maturity

[TO WRITE: Cross-border care payments. Specialty token pools. DAO governance transition. Provider-to-provider settlement. Research data marketplace.]

11. Team, Governance & Legal Structure

11.1 Founding Team

[TO WRITE: Team bios, relevant experience in healthcare data, credentialing, provider networks, and blockchain/fintech. Advisory board targets.]

11.2 Legal Entity Structure

[TO WRITE: Foundation structure. Operating company. DAO transition roadmap. IP ownership and licensing.]

11.3 Progressive Decentralization

[TO WRITE: Governance transition timeline. Solana Realms-based DAO implementation. Voting mechanisms, quorum requirements, and proposal lifecycle.]

12. Financial Projections & Funding

12.1 Revenue Model

[TO WRITE: Revenue streams and 5-year projection. Reference companion tokenomics spreadsheet (Zypher_Tokenomics_Model_v02.xlsx).]

12.2 Funding Requirements

[TO WRITE: Phase 1 costs (~\$300–\$500 for Solana deployment). Phase 2 engineering investment for zCARE custom program. Seed round, Series A timeline. Use of funds breakdown.]

12.3 Token Generation Event

[TO WRITE: TGE structure via Smithii.io deployment. Initial liquidity via Raydium ZPH/SOL pool (\$200–\$300). Jupiter aggregator listing. Future CEX listing strategy.]

13. Risk Factors & Mitigations

[TO WRITE: Comprehensive risk matrix covering: (a) Regulatory risk. (b) Stability risk (zCARE depeg events). (c) Adoption risk. (d) Technical risk (Solana network outages, smart contract vulnerability). (e) Competitive risk. (f) Macro risk (crypto market downturns affecting ZPH value). (g) Solana-specific risks (network congestion, validator centralization concerns). For each: likelihood, impact, and mitigation.]

14. Conclusion

[TO WRITE: Restate the vision. Zypher's dual-token architecture on Solana, grounded in real healthcare data and verified provider identities, delivers a protocol-level solution to healthcare's payment crisis. Call to action for target audiences.]

Appendices

Appendix A: Glossary of Terms

[TO WRITE: Healthcare terms (NPI, CPT, HCPCS, RVU, FQHC, HPSA) and Solana/crypto terms (SPL token, PDA, Anchor, Raydium, Jupiter, Pyth, stablecoin, DAO).]

Appendix B: Detailed Tokenomics Model

[TO WRITE: Reference companion Excel workbook: Zypher_Tokenomics_Model_v02.xlsx. Supply schedules, fee projections, burn rates, and scenario analysis.]

Appendix C: Solana Deployment Guide

[TO WRITE: Step-by-step deployment record. Smithii.io configuration, Raydium pool creation, Jupiter metadata submission. Contract address documentation.]

Appendix D: Regulatory Jurisdiction Analysis

[TO WRITE: State-by-state regulatory landscape for money transmission and digital asset classification.]

Appendix E: Competitive Landscape

[TO WRITE: Detailed analysis of existing healthcare payment innovations, healthcare-adjacent crypto projects (MedToken, Solve.Care, Patientory), and traditional fintech competitors.]